8.02 Objectives of SEBI

The various objectives of a Stock Exchange are explained below

1. Regulation of Stock Exchanges

The first objective of SEBI is to regulate stock exchanges so that efficient services may be provided to all the parties operating there.

2. Protection to the Investors

The capital market is meaningless in the absence of the investors. Therefore, it is important to protect the interests of the investors. The protection of the interests of the investors means protecting them from the wrong information given by the companies in their prospectus, reducing the risk of delivery and payment, etc. Hence, the foremost objective of the SEBI is to provide security to the investors.

3. Checking the Insider Trading

Insider trading means the buying and selling of securities by directors Promoters, etc. who have access to some confidential information about the company and who wish to take advantage of this confidential information. This affects the interests of the general investors and is essential to check this tendency. Many steps have been taken to check insider trading through the medium of the SEBI.

4. Control over Brokers

It is important to supervise/check the activities of the brokers and other middlemen in order to control the capital market. To regulate their activities, it was necessary to establish the SEBI.

8.03 Functions of SEBI

Securities and Exchange Board of India (frequently abbreviated **SEBI)** is the nodal agency which safeguards the interests of an investor in the Indian Financial market. SEBI performs three key functions: **quasi-legislative, quasi-judicial and quasi-executive.** It drafts regulations, conducts investigation & enforcement action and it passes rulings and orders.

i. Safeguarding the interests of investors by means of adequate education and guidance. SEBI makes rules and regulation that must be followed by the financial intermediaries like portfolio exchanges, underwriters and merchant bankers, etc. It takes care of the complaints received from investors . Additionally, it issues notices and booklets for the information, assistance and protection of small investors.

ii. Regulating and controlling the business on stock markets. Registration of brokers and sub-brokers is made mandatory and they have to abide by certain regulations and rules.

iii. Conduct inspection and inquiries of stock exchanges, intermediaries and self-regulating organizations and to take appropriate measures wherever required. This function is carried out for organized working of stock exchanges and intermediaries.

iv. Barring insider trading in securities.

v. Prohibiting deceptive and unfair methods used by financial intermediaries operating in securities markets.

vi. Registering and controlling the functioning of stock brokers, sub-brokers, share transfer agents, bankers, trustees, registrars, merchant bankers, underwriters, portfolio managers, investment advisers and various other intermediaries who might be linked to securities markets in any manner.

vii. SEBI issues Guidelines and Instructions to businesses concerning capital issues. Separate guidelines are provided for initial public issue made by listed companies, etc. It conducts research and publishes information beneficial to all market players (i.e. all buyers and sellers).

viii. SEBI regulates mergers and acquisitions as a way to protect the interest of investors. For this, SEBI has released appropriate guidelines with the intention that such mergers and takeovers won't be at the expense of small investors.

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